

AGENTS.md

Quick maintenance notes for agent-driven edits to `mdexplore`. For full architecture and behavior details, see `DEVELOPERS-AGENTS.md`.

UI Controls That Must Be Preserved

- Top-left navigation actions include:
 - `Recent` (dropdown menu)
 - `^`
 - `Refresh`
 - `PDF`
 - `Add View`
 - `Edit`
- The `Recent` menu sits to the left of `^`.
- The `Recent` dropdown must show up to 35 retained root directories using this presentation:
 - first 10 shown most-recent-first,
 - then a separator,
 - then up to 25 remaining entries sorted alphabetically.
- A root should be recorded only after it has been active for at least 30 seconds and the user navigates to another root.

Search + Scope Styling Rules

- Active search should run across markdown files currently visible in the tree (root + expanded branches), not just a single effective-scope directory.
- If search is active and tree visibility changes (expand/collapse/root/scope navigation), search should rerun automatically.
- Matching file rows should stay bold+italic with left-gutter hit-count pills.
- Filename-term matches should keep yellow filename text.
- Effective-root directory row should stay bold and:
 - aqua-blue (`#7fdfe8`) when no active search hits are under it,
 - yellow with an appended hit-count pill when active search has hits under it.
- Effective-root search-hit pill should mirror file-pill formatting (`1 . 99` , then `++`).

Recent Directory Persistence Rules

- Config file: `~/ .mdexplore.cfg`
- Lock file: `~/ .mdexplore.cfg.lock`
- Config payload (JSON):
 - `default_root` : string path
 - `recent_roots` : array of string paths (max 35, rolling most-recent-first storage)
 - `copy_base64_images_enabled` : boolean toggle state for copy-time BASE64 embedding
- Writes occur on root navigation and again on shutdown.
- Backward compatibility: legacy plain-text config (single path line) must continue to load.
- Multi-instance behavior:
 - The `Recent` menu must re-read disk config each time the menu opens.
 - Config updates should use short non-blocking lock attempts; if lock acquisition fails, skip save silently.
 - Lock files older than 2 minutes should be deleted automatically and silently.

Copy Toolbar Rules

- The copy area includes:
 - destination radios (`Clipboard` , `Directory`)
 - pin copy button
 - highlight-color copy buttons
 - BASE64 image toggle button (image icons on/off)
- PDF export should inline retrievable `<img>` sources to BASE64 data URIs before print; unresolved/broken links should remain unchanged.
- BASE64 toggle behavior:
 - Default is disabled on startup.
 - State should load from/persist to `~/ .mdexplore.cfg` .
 - Tooltip when disabled: `Turn BASE64 image encoding on` .
 - Tooltip when enabled: `Turn BASE64 image encoding off` .
 - Applies only to copied outputs (clipboard staging and directory copy), never mutates source markdown files.
 - Retrievable image links (`file:` /relative paths/HTTP(S)) are embedded as BASE64 data URIs; unresolved links remain unchanged.

Rendering and Performance Rules

- Markdown rendering should default to `cmarkgfm` fast path with automatic fallback to `markdown-it-py` for compatibility cases.
- `MDEXPLORE_MARKDOWN_ENGINE` should continue to support `cmark` (default), `markdown-it`, and `auto`.
- Startup-generated icon assets (app icon normalization and two-tone icon recolors) should persist under `~/.cache/mdexplore/icon-cache` and be reused on later launches unless source asset identity/render parameters change.
- Launcher runtime import verification should use and refresh `.venv/.runtime-import-check.sha256` (requirements-hash stamp) so the full import probe is not rerun on every launch.
- Shared BASE64 encode/decode helpers should remain in `mdexplore_app/fast_base64.py`, using adaptive routing between vendored `fastbase64` and `pybase64`, with `stdlib` fallback.
- Vendor `fastbase64` encode output must be validated before use; on malformed output, helpers should silently fall back to `pybase64/stdlib` so PlantUML and other `data:` URI consumers do not break.
- `MDEXPLORE_BASE64_IMAGE_THREADS` controls worker-pool size used for both preview inline data-image materialization and copy-time image-link prefetch.